



UNIVERSITY OF CAMBRIDGE INTERNATIONAL EXAMINATIONS
International General Certificate of Secondary Education

FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/32

Paper 3 Directed Writing and Composition

October/November 2013

READING BOOKLET INSERT

2 hours

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

This Reading Booklet Insert contains the reading passage for use with **Section 1, Question 1** on the Question Paper.

You may annotate this Insert and use the blank spaces for planning. This Insert is **not** assessed by the Examiner.

This document consists of **2** printed pages and **2** blank pages.



Read the following article carefully, and then answer Question 1 on the Question Paper.

Why I'm teaching happiness

Helping to produce happy young adults when they leave school at 18 is my highest priority as Headteacher. I have been saying this for the last ten years, but only in the past year have I begun to realise this isn't just an unachievable aspiration, but one can in fact learn happiness in class. Hence my decision to teach happiness and positive psychology in timetabled lessons at my school.

I believe that our education in schools is fundamentally ill-balanced. Of course exams matter greatly – they are the passport to an individual's higher education and career. A school which fails to allow every child to achieve the best grades of which he or she is capable is failing to do its job properly. However, education is far more than this, which is why judging a school on exam results alone is wrong. Results tables say nothing about the quality of the teaching, about the wider life of the school, or whether it is turning out resentful and ill-balanced young adults, or whether it is helping to produce young men and women who are happy and who know themselves and what they want to do in life.

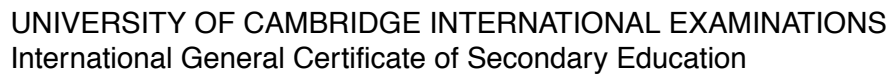
As a teacher, I have seen far too many tortured and unhappy pupils who have achieved top results beyond their secondary education. If they can achieve these grades while leading balanced lives, taking part in a wide variety of activities which will develop different aspects of their character, and if they blossom as human beings, then all is well and good. However, this isn't always the case with high achievers. People who are driven, or pushed, see their lives flash by and most fail to realise they are missing the point in life. Is it more important to be highly successful, or to have sound relationships with friends, colleagues and parents, and indeed to become a loving parent whose children are valued and treasured?

Hence the need to teach happiness in school, when individuals are still having their characters formed. It is much harder to acquire good habits later in life.

What will these lessons involve? These will not be lessons like History or Physics, where acquiring knowledge is all important. This is about emotional learning and emotional intelligence, and is far more thought-provoking than a traditional subject. Pupils will learn about how to form healthy and sustaining relationships. They will gain understanding about the goals they should want to set in life, which should be realistic and appropriate for their own talents and interests. Negative emotions, which are an inevitable part of life, will be explored: pupils will be able to learn more about what it is that causes them pain or unhappiness, how they might be able to avoid or minimise these emotions, and how to deal with them when they do occur. So, the whole point is that pupils learn more about themselves, which will be information that they will be able to use for the rest of their lives.

Are these types of lessons relevant? Ask any parent. Would they sooner see their children happy and fulfilled, even at the cost of achieving slightly less, or stressed out and vexed in the pursuit of ever-higher goals which always seem to be beyond their reach? Happiness, I believe, lies in knowing one's own limitations, accepting oneself for what one is, and being proud of what one achieves, at whatever level that might be.

Once at university, the purpose of these happiness lessons becomes crystal clear, as students have to manage without the presence of caring parents, teachers and familiar friends. Loneliness, depression and rejection can strike, and young people find it difficult to cope if schools send them off ill-prepared to deal with real life. Schools also fall short in preparing their leavers to manage money, accommodation and being able to look after themselves. I believe all schools should rise to the challenge of producing young men and women who will be able to contribute to society all the better for being more confident about themselves and their place in the world.



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Candidates answer on the Question Paper.

Write your Centre number, candidate number and name in the spaces provided.
Write in dark blue or black pen.
Do **not** use staples, paper clips, glue or correction fluid.

DO **NOT** WRITE IN ANY BARCODES.

Answer **two** questions: **Question 1** in **Section 1** and **one** question from **Section 2**. Answer in the space provided. If additional space is required, you should use the lined pages at the end of this booklet. The question number(s) must be clearly shown.

Dictionaries are **not** permitted.

The Reading Booklet Insert contains the reading passage for use with **Question 1, Section 1** on this Question Paper. The Insert is **not** assessed by the Examiner.

The number of marks is given in brackets [] at the end of each question or part question.

This document consists of **10** printed pages, **2** blank pages and **1** Reading Booklet Insert.

1 Read carefully the article on ‘*Why I’m teaching happiness*’ in the Reading Booklet Insert and then answer Section 1, Question 1 on this Question Paper.

You may agree or disagree with the Headteacher's arguments.

- explore and evaluate the Headteacher's views
- use your own ideas to support your comments on the Headteacher's views.

Base your letter on the article, but be careful to use your own words.

Begin your letter: 'Dear Headteacher...'.

Write between 1½ and 2 sides, allowing for the size of your handwriting.

Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 15 marks for the quality of your writing.

[illegible]

[illegible]

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al: 25]

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Section 2: Composition

Write about two sides, allowing for the size of your handwriting, on **one** of the following questions.

Up to 13 marks are available for the content and structure of your answer, and up to 12 marks are available for the style and accuracy of your writing.

Argumentative/Discursive Writing

- 2 (a) Should a government influence people's diets? What are your views?

OR

- (b) 'Combat sports, where the aim is to injure one's opponent, should be banned.' What are your views on this subject?

Descriptive Writing

- 3 (a) You come across an abandoned building you never knew existed. Describe its exterior and surroundings before giving details of how you enter. Describe the atmosphere inside and everything your senses experience as you explore the building.

OR

- (b) Describe a place called 'Paradise on Earth'.

Narrative Writing

- 4 (a) Write a story entitled 'The Great Pretender'.

OR

- (b) Write about how an old film had been obtained secretly.

[Turn to page 6 to answer Section 2]

[illegible]

For
Examiner's
Use

If you use the following lined pages to complete the answer(s) to any question(s), the question number(s) must be clearly shown.

[illegible]